MAMDOUH ALENEZI, Ph.D.

AI Strategy & Digital Transformation Executive | Saudi Government & National Programs

National AI Capability · AI & Technology Governance · Enterprise Architecture

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Saudi technology and transformation executive with nearly 12 years of progressive leadership across a national AI authority, a national technology company, and a research university. General Manager of SDAIA Academy, the capability-development arm of the Saudi Data & Artificial Intelligence Authority, accountable for a SAR 13M budget and the Kingdom's data and AI talent agenda under Vision 2030 and the Human Capability Development Program. Track record of converting national strategy into governed, KPI-measured delivery: 6,000+ specialized professionals trained in a single four-month cycle at 92% satisfaction; a SAR 600M technology portfolio governed with enterprise-architecture maturity raised from Level 2 to Level 4; and 278 senior government leaders trained in AI decision-making to date. Full Professor of Software Engineering and Prosci® Certified Change Practitioner, trusted to brief ministers, deputy ministers, boards, and regional policy bodies.

SELECTED EXECUTIVE RESULTS

- **SAR 600M technology portfolio** governed at Tahakom; enterprise-architecture maturity raised from Level 2 to Level 4, CMMI achieved, software defect rates reduced by 36%, and three audit cycles closed successfully.
- **6,000+ data and AI professionals** trained by SDAIA Academy in one four-month summer cycle, with 92% average learner satisfaction, a selective 38% acceptance rate, and 196+ documented graduate success stories.
- **National training consolidation:** integrated the Information Technology Institute into SDAIA Academy, absorbing 68+ programs, 6,000+ trainees, and 70+ staff into one governed operating model.
- **278 senior government leaders** (C-level executives, deputy ministers, Grades 14–15) trained in AI leadership and governance against a 600-leader national target.
- **SAR 4M institution-wide ERP** delivered in four months for 500 users at Prince Sultan University, re-engineering all HR, finance, accounting, and procurement processes.
- **First-year student attrition reduced from 42% to 36%** through an analytics-driven study and targeted policy interventions.

EXECUTIVE EXPERTISE

- AI Strategy & National Roadmaps
- Government Digital Transformation
- Technology & AI Governance
- Responsible AI & Regulation
- Enterprise Architecture
- Portfolio & Investment Governance
- Transformation PMO
- Target Operating Model Design
- Organizational Design & Integration
- Change Management (Prosci)
- National AI Capability & Talent
- Government AI Leadership
- KPI Design & Performance Systems
- Quality Systems (ISO, CMMI)
- Accreditation (ABET, AACSB)
- ERP & Process Re-engineering
- Strategic Partnerships & Alliances
- Ministerial & Board Engagement
- Vision 2030 & HCDP Alignment

EXECUTIVE EXPERIENCE

Saudi Data & Artificial Intelligence Authority (SDAIA)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

General Manager, SDAIA Academy

03/2026 – Present

Enterprise accountability for strategy, portfolio, quality, partnerships, and performance; SAR 13M annual budget; five operating units; advanced training, bootcamp, and professional-certification programs.

- **National strategy ownership:** Direct the Kingdom's data and AI talent-development agenda, translating Vision 2030, the National Strategy for Data & AI, and Human Capability Development Program targets into a governed, KPI-measured national portfolio of advanced training, bootcamps, and professional certification.
- **Delivery at national scale:** Trained 6,000+ specialized data and AI professionals in a single four-month summer cycle while sustaining 92% average learner satisfaction and a selective 38% acceptance rate; documented 196+ graduate success stories evidencing career and organizational impact.
- **Portfolio consolidation and integration:** Led the integration of the Information Technology Institute into the Academy (August 2026), absorbing 68+ training programs, 6,000+ trainees, and 70+ staff; owned the transition communication plan and executive engagement to unify national technology training under one governed platform.
- **AI leadership for government decision-makers:** Launched an AI Executive Program for senior ministry leadership

(October 2026), with sequential rollout across the Ministries of Hajj & Umrah, Education, Municipalities & Housing, and Energy; 278 C-level executives, deputy ministers, and Grade 14–15 leaders trained to date against a 600-leader target, building the leadership capacity to identify, govern, and scale AI in government.

- **Performance architecture redesign:** Following reorganization into five operating units, consolidated duplicated legacy indicators into 12 core KPIs within a two-tier model (8-KPI executive scorecard plus unit-level KPIs), shifting institutional measurement from training completion to skills attainment, employment, and professional impact.
- **Strategic partnership portfolio:** Govern a 26-partner portfolio spanning global technology leaders (NVIDIA, Microsoft, IBM, Google Cloud, ServiceNow, Rackspace), Stanford and Oxford, 15 Saudi universities, and national enablers (Ministry of Education, Tuwaiq Academy, Misk); oversee the Generative AI Academy delivered with NVIDIA.
- **Capability architecture:** Architected a modular, stackable learning-path catalog spanning Data Scientist and AI Engineer tracks, from workforce AI literacy to expert-level agentic AI systems engineering, enabling accredited progression from foundation to expert.
- **International quality standards:** Completed the ISO 21001:2025 baseline assessment and launched the certification implementation plan; established an instructor evaluation and accreditation framework anchored to ISO 21001 and Kirkpatrick outcome levels.
- **Regional policy leadership:** Chair the Capacity Building & Partnerships team of the Arab Standing Committee on Artificial Intelligence, leading the regional capacity-building agenda across Arab member states.

Tahakom (national smart-mobility & public-safety technology company)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Director, AI Academy & Acting Director, Technology Governance 08/2024 – 03/2026

Dual executive mandate: enterprise AI capability building and company-wide technology governance, enterprise architecture, and assurance of a SAR 600M technology portfolio; led 50+ staff.

- **Transformation governance:** Redefined the technology governance operating model and raised enterprise-architecture maturity from Level 2 to Level 4, aligning a SAR 600M technology investment portfolio with corporate strategy and transformation objectives.
- **Enterprise PMO and assurance:** Authored and institutionalized an enterprise PMO playbook spanning the full project lifecycle; led governance audits, maturity assessments, and remediation roadmaps, closing three successive audit cycles successfully and securing value realization across the portfolio.
- **Engineering excellence:** Overhauled policies, processes, and the SDLC with CMMI-aligned quality controls and CI/CD-enabled DevOps; achieved CMMI and reduced software defect rates by 36% while improving release speed and traceability.
- **Opportunity-to-launch process:** Deployed an end-to-end cross-business-unit process for developing, approving, and launching new business opportunities, replacing ad hoc hand-offs with defined ownership and decision gates.
- **Enterprise AI capability ecosystem:** Trained and certified 500+ employees through structured, competency-based AI programs and recurring AI town halls delivered with KAUST, Google, Qwen, CNTXT, and CAMEL-AI.
- **Advanced AI talent pipeline:** Founded an AI scholarship program sponsoring five engineers for master's degrees in AI at top-30 global universities, including New York University and the National University of Singapore.

Prince Sultan University

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Private university of about 7,000 students (13:1 student-to-faculty ratio), ranked first nationally for graduate employability; progressive and partly concurrent executive roles, 2015–2024.

Founding Dean, College of Space & Aviation Sciences 04/2024 – 08/2024

- **Institution building:** Established the Kingdom's first college of its kind, in collaboration with the Saudi Space Agency and NASA, defining academic vision, governance structure, and an initial portfolio of four bachelor's and three master's programs aligned with national space and aviation ambitions.
- **International benchmarking:** Forged partnerships with universities hosting established space and aviation colleges to transfer expertise and align programs with international practice.

Dean, Quality Assurance & Development 09/2020 – 08/2024

- **Accreditation at scale:** Secured international accreditation across engineering, computing, business, law, and humanities: ABET (Engineering) for Software Engineering; ABET (Computing) for Computer Science and Information Systems; AACSB for all College of Business programs; and HCÉRES for all programs in the Colleges of Law and Humanities; alongside national institutional accreditation from NCAAA/ETEC and ISO certifications.
- **Institutional strategy:** Led the university's fourth strategic plan (seven years, five strategic themes under the DRIVE framework) and implemented a university-wide Quality Management System embedding continuous improvement across academic and administrative units.

Dean, Educational Services 09/2018 – 08/2020

- **Student-journey governance:** Owned the end-to-end student journey; restructured the Preparatory Year Program into an independent department and tightened governance of placement testing, evaluation, and advising.
- **Evidence-based retention:** Led an analytics-driven study of first-year attrition and introduced targeted policy interventions in English and mathematics, reducing first-year attrition from 42% to 36%.

Chief Information & Technology Officer 01/2015 – 08/2019

- **Digital transformation:** Authored and executed a three-year digital transformation strategy; delivered a SAR 4M institution-wide ERP for 500 users in four months, automating and re-engineering all HR, finance, accounting, and procurement processes on a scalable, integrated infrastructure.
- **Data-driven leadership:** Built an automated faculty evaluation system across research, teaching, community service, and professional development, giving leadership a quantified basis for performance decisions.

Chair, Department of Computer Science 09/2015 – 08/2016

- Redesigned the curriculum to IEEE, ACM, and ABET standards, institutionalized structured employer feedback, and recruited and retained high-caliber faculty.

ADVISORY, BOARD & POLICY ENGAGEMENT

- **Chair, Capacity Building & Partnerships Team, Arab Standing Committee on Artificial Intelligence** (2026 – Present): regional capacity-building agenda and monthly policy reporting across Arab member states.
- **Strategic Planning Consultant, CYBEX, Prince Sultan University** (11/2023 – Present): strategy formulation, multi-stakeholder workshops, and vision-to-initiative documentation.
- **Principal Investigator, KACST-funded research** (2017 – 2018): machine-learning-driven dynamic capacity provisioning for cloud networks.
- **University governance:** member of eight university-level committees, including Strategic Planning and ABET Steering.

EDUCATION & EXECUTIVE CREDENTIALS

- **Ph.D., Software Engineering**, North Dakota State University, USA (2014) · **M.S., Software Engineering**, DePaul University, USA (2011) · **B.S., Computer Science**, Prince Sultan University (2010)
- **Prosci® Certified Change Practitioner** (2025) · **Strategy Specialization**, Harvard Business School Online (2024): Strategy Execution, Disruptive Strategy, Sustainable Business Strategy

ACADEMIC STANDING & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- **Full Professor of Software Engineering**, Prince Sultan University (2022–2024; faculty since 2014). Peer-reviewed research in AI-native and agentic software engineering, AI governance, AI in education, and innovation management informs the frameworks applied in executive practice.
- Designed the B.S. and M.S. in Software Engineering, the M.S. in Cybersecurity Engineering, and a Digital Transformation track; General Chair of three international data science and machine learning conferences (SDMA 2018; CDMA 2020, 2024); program committee member for 13+ international conferences; reviewer for 11 indexed journals, including *ACM Computing Surveys*.